



Template [2026] for Data Protection Impact Assessment ('DPIA')

Version 1.0

Adopted on 10 March 2026

Version history

Version	Date	Adoption information
version 1.0	10 March 2026	adoption of the guidelines for public consultation

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The European Data Protection Board has adopted the following template:

0 OVERVIEW OF THE PROCESSING

0.1 Controller(s)

Note: If there are Joint controllers, one table per controller, adding a row to identify their obligations and tasks

Controller	
Management units responsible for the processing inside the organisation	
Main establishment/point of contact or representative	
Information about the DPO or similar function, if applicable	

0.2 Processor(s) and sub-processor(s)

	Processor	Definition of their obligations and tasks
1		
2		
N		

0.3 Name of the processing

Internal name given to the processing (the given name in the record of processing activities)	
Current version (explaining the history of changes made to the processing in the past, if any)	

0.4 Planning of the processing

Estimated launch date	
Estimated end date or expiration conditions (if applicable, i.e. because the processing is temporary)	

0.5 DPIA technical sheet

Current version and version log (explaining the history of changes made to the information contained in the DPIA template for this processing, if any)	
Team involved in conducting this DPIA (providing details of their roles, tasks, responsibilities, etc.)	
Guidelines, standards, codes of conduct and other reference materials used to conduct this DPIA ¹	
Reasons to conduct the DPIA ²	1. New processing activity, DPIA likely to be required due to high-risk (legal obligation under Article 35.3 GDPR): ☐ Systematic and extensive evaluation of personal aspects relating to natural persons which is based on automated processing, including profiling, and on which decisions are based that produce legal effects concerning the natural person or similarly significantly affect the natural person. ☐ Processing on a large scale of special categories of data referred to in Article 9(1), or of personal data relating to criminal convictions and offences referred to in Article 10. ☐ Systematic monitoring of a publicly accessible area on a large scale. 2. New processing activity, DPIA likely to be required due to likely high-risk (legal obligation under national law): Explanation: _____ 3. New processing activity, DPIA likely to be required due to likely high-risk (following EDPB and national guidance): ☐ Evaluation or scoring, including profiling and predicting, especially from “aspects concerning the data subject's performance at work, economic situation, health, personal preferences or interests, reliability or behaviour, location or movements”. ☐ Automated-decision making with legal or similar significant effect: processing that aims at taking decisions on data subjects producing “legal effects concerning the natural person” or which “similarly significantly affects the natural person”. ☐ Systematic monitoring: processing used to observe, monitor or control data subjects, including data collected through networks or “a systematic monitoring of a publicly accessible area”. ☐ Sensitive data or data of a highly personal nature: this includes special categories of personal data as defined in Article 9 (for example information about individuals’ political opinions), as well as personal data relating to criminal convictions or offences as defined in Article 10.

¹ Guidelines on Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA) (wp248rev.01), https://ec.europa.eu/newsroom/just/document.cfm?doc_id=47711

² Idem.

	☐ Data processed on a large scale, considering the number of data subjects concerned, either as a specific number or as a proportion of the relevant population; the volume of data and/or the range of different data items being processed; the duration, or permanence, of the data processing activity; the geographical extent of the processing activity. ☐ Matching or combining datasets. ☐ Data concerning vulnerable data subjects (because of the increased power imbalance between the data subjects and the data controller, meaning the individuals may be unable to easily consent to, or oppose, the processing of their data, or exercise their rights.) ☐ Innovative use or applying new technological or organisational solutions. ☐ When the processing in itself “prevents data subjects from exercising a right or using a service or a contract”. ☐ Other (for example, national list regarding the processing operations subject to the requirement of a data protection impact assessment): _____ 4. New processing activity, DPIA necessary or beneficial: ☐ DPO opinion or recommendation. ☐ Data subjects’ (or their representatives’) opinion or recommendation. ☐ Required by a code of conduct, standard, best practice, etc. ☐ Other (for example for managing risk or demonstrating accountability and building trust): _____ 5. Existing high-risk processing activity for which there has been a change of the risks: ☐ Data processing has changed. ☐ The organisational or societal context for the processing activity has changed. How? _____
Scope of this DPIA (what has been considered and what has been left out of the assessment and why)	
Completion date	
Formal validation date (approval of the DPIA as complete and finished by a responsible official)	
Is the DPIA (or parts of it) intended to be published or to be shared externally?	☐ No ☐ Yes it is going to be published: How? _____ ☐ Yes, it is going to be shared externally: How? _____

1 SYSTEMATIC DESCRIPTION OF THE PROCESSING

1.1 High-level description of the processing

1.1.a Processed personal data

	Processed personal data (item or element)	Explanation (data type, data subject category, additional details)	Special category of personal data
1			☐ No Yes: ☐ Data revealing racial or ethnic origin, political opinions, religious or philosophical beliefs, or trade union membership. ☐ Genetic data. ☐ Biometric data for the purpose of uniquely identifying a natural person. ☐ Data concerning health. ☐ Data concerning a natural person's sex life or sexual orientation.

1.1.b Purposes of the processing

	Purpose: specific and explicit reasons for processing the personal data	Personal data involved (considering personal data listed in 1.1.a) and justification
1		
2		
N		

1.1.c Secondary or compatible uses

	Secondary or compatible uses of the data	Personal data involved (considering personal data listed in 1.1.a), under what conditions and assessment of compatibility
1		
2		
N		

1.1.d Nature, scope and context of the processing

Nature of the processing: the way personal data will be handled (operations involved, technologies used, etc.).	
Scope of the processing: breadth and extent (the volume or scale given the number of data subjects or data items, geographical and organisational reach, frequency or duration for the data subject, etc.).	
Context of the processing: circumstances and environment (use cases, supported business processes, status of the controller and relationship with the data subjects, data subjects categories and potential vulnerable groups, cross-border processing, international transfers, etc.).	Is this a cross-border processing? ☐ No ☐ Yes (justification and details): _____ Is personal data going to be transferred to a recipient in a third country or international organisation? ☐ No ☐ Yes (justification and details): _____

1.2 Functional description

Note: Ideally, this table should be supplemented with one or more diagrams representing data flows or a similar figure.

	Processing phase or stage	Type of operations	Explanation
1		☐ Collection ☐ Use ☐ Storage ☐ Sharing and Transfer ☐ Deletion and Destruction	

1.3 Means of processing, supporting assets and underlying architecture

Processing phase or stage (considering the functional description under 1.2)	Means of processing and supporting assets	Explanation

1.4 Compliance with approved codes of conduct

	Code of conduct	Explanation
1		☐ Compliance is likely to be required (legal obligation). Why?: _____ ☐ Compliance is necessary or beneficial. Why?: _____

2 ANALYSIS OF THE PROCESSING

2.1 Lawfulness of the processing

2.1.a Legal basis

Purpose/use (considering 1.1.b on processing purposes and 1.1.c on secondary or compatible purposes)	Legal basis (Article 6(1) GDPR)	Justification (if applicable, analyse the legitimate interests pursued by the controller or by a third party conducting a balancing test ³)
	☐ (a) The data subject has given consent to the processing of his or her personal data for one or more specific purposes. ☐ (b) The processing is necessary for the performance of a contract to which the data subject is party or in order to take steps at the request of the data subject prior to entering into a contract. ☐ (c) The processing is necessary for compliance with a legal obligation to which the controller is subject.	

³ EDPB Guidelines 1/2024 on processing of personal data based on Article 6(1)(f) GDPR:
https://www.edpb.europa.eu/system/files/2024-10/edpb_guidelines_202401_legitimateinterest_en.pdf

	☐ (d) The processing is necessary in order to protect the vital interests of the data subject or of another natural person. ☐ (e) The processing is necessary for the performance of a task carried out in the public interest or in the exercise of official authority vested in the controller. ☐ (f) The processing is necessary for the purposes of the legitimate interests pursued by the controller or by a third party, except where such interests are overridden by the interests or fundamental rights and freedoms of the data subject which require protection of personal data, in particular where the data subject is a child.	
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2.1.b Reasons to lift the processing prohibition

Special category of personal data (item or element, considering 1.1.a)	Reasons to lift the processing prohibition (Article 9(2) GDPR)	Justification
	☐ (a) The data subject has given explicit consent to the processing of those personal data for one or more specified purposes, except where Union or Member State law provide that the prohibition may not be lifted by the data subject. ☐ (b) The processing is necessary for the purposes of carrying out the obligations and exercising specific rights of the controller or of the data subject in the field of employment and social security and social protection law in so far as it is authorised by Union or Member State law or a collective agreement pursuant to Member State law providing for appropriate safeguards for the fundamental rights and the interests of the data subject. ☐ (c) The processing is necessary to protect the vital interests of the data subject or of another natural person where the data subject is physically or legally incapable of giving consent. ☐ (d) The processing is carried out in the course of its legitimate activities with appropriate safeguards by a foundation, association or any other not-for-profit body with a political, philosophical, religious or trade union aim and on condition that the processing relates solely to the members or to former members of the body or to persons who have regular contact with it in connection with its purposes and that the personal data are not disclosed outside that body without the consent of the data subjects. ☐ (e) The processing relates to personal data which are manifestly made public by the data subject. ☐ (f) The processing is necessary for the establishment, exercise or defence of legal claims or whenever courts are acting in their judicial capacity. ☐ (g) The processing is necessary for reasons of substantial public interest, on the basis of Union or	

	Member State law which shall be proportionate to the aim pursued, respect the essence of the right to data protection and provide for suitable and specific measures to safeguard the fundamental rights and the interests of the data subject. ☐ (h) The processing is necessary for the purposes of preventive or occupational medicine, for the assessment of the working capacity of the employee, medical diagnosis, the provision of health or social care or treatment or the management of health or social care systems and services on the basis of Union or Member State law or pursuant to contract with a health professional and subject to the conditions and safeguards referred to in paragraph 3 article 9 GDPR. ☐ (i) The processing is necessary for reasons of public interest in the area of public health, such as protecting against serious cross-border threats to health or ensuring high standards of quality and safety of health care and of medicinal products or medical devices, on the basis of Union or Member State law which provides for suitable and specific measures to safeguard the rights and freedoms of the data subject, in particular professional secrecy. ☐ (j) The processing is necessary for archiving purposes in the public interest, scientific or historical research purposes or statistical purposes in accordance with Article 89(1) GDPR based on Union or Member State law which shall be proportionate to the aim pursued, respect the essence of the right to data protection and provide for suitable and specific measures to safeguard the fundamental rights and the interests of the data subject.	
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2.2 Data minimisation, retention periods, and data quality

2.2.a Data minimisation and retention periods

Processed personal data (item or element, considering 1.1.a)	Justification of the need and relevance of the data	Recipients	Justification	Retention period	Justification

2.2.b Data quality

Processed personal data (item or element, considering table 1.1.a)	Quality metrics, requirements or thresholds	Justification

2.3 Measures supporting compliance

2.3.a Measures supporting compliance with principles in Article 5(1)(a-f) GDPR

Compliance with Article 5(1)(a-f) GDPR principles	List of supporting measures	Discussion of appropriateness and effectiveness	Implementation status
Fairness principle			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented
Transparency principle			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented
Purpose limitation principle			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented
Data minimisation principle			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented
Accuracy principle			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented
Storage limitation principle			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented
Integrity and confidentiality principle			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented
Accountability principle			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented

2.3.b Measures supporting the exercise of data subjects' rights

Data subject rights	List of supporting measures	Discussion appropriateness and effectiveness	Implementation status
Information to be provided to the data subjects (Articles 12, 13 and 14 GDPR)			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented
Right of access and to data portability (Articles 15 and 20 GDPR)			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented
Right to rectification and to erasure (Articles 16, 17 and 19 GDPR)			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented
Right to object and to restriction of processing (Article 18, 19 and 21 GDPR)			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented
Right not to be subject to a decision based solely on automated processing (Article 22 GDPR)			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented

2.3.c Measures supporting compliance with other GDPR requirements

Compliance with other GDPR requirements	List of supporting measures	Discussion appropriateness and effectiveness	Implementation status
Requirements on the provisions and withdrawal of consent (Article 7 GDPR)			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented
Relationship with processors (Article 28 GDPR)			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented

Safeguards relating to international transfer(s) (Chapter V GDPR)			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented
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2.3.d Measures supporting data protection by design and by default

Data protection by design and by default (Article 25 GDPR)	List of supporting measures	Discussion of appropriateness and effectiveness	Implementation status
			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented
			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented

2.3.e Measures supporting security of processing

Security of processing (Article 32 GDPR)	List of supporting measures	Discussion of appropriateness and effectiveness	Implementation status (planned/partially implemented/implemented)
			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented
			☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented

3 CONSIDERATIONS ON NECESSITY AND PROPORTIONALITY

3.1 Impacts of the processing on the rights and freedoms of data subjects

	Threats posed by the processing, as it has been designed and planned to be implemented (including technical, legal/contractual and organisational measures to mitigate risk(s))	How can it be materialised?	Risk sources (purpose, wrong design and weaknesses, exposures, etc.)	Impact on data subjects' rights and freedoms
1				

3.2 Assess the necessity of the processing⁴

Evaluate if the envisaged processing is effective and the least intrusive for the data subject's rights and freedoms⁵. Provide evidence (for example, concerning the different considered alternatives) and justification.

3.3 Assess the proportionality of the processing⁶

Discuss the importance of the processing and its potential benefits for the data subject and collectively. Conduct an evaluation that compares the potential impacts on rights and freedoms of data subjects with the advantages resulting from the processing, to ensure that the processing is proportional and fairly balanced. Provide evidence and justification.

4 EDPS "Assessing the necessity of measures that limit the fundamental right to the protection of personal data: A Toolkit", https://www.edps.europa.eu/sites/default/files/publication/17-04-11_necessity_toolkit_en_0.pdf

5 EDPB "Guidelines 1/2024 on processing of personal data based on Article 6(1)(f) GDPR", section II.B, paragraph 29, https://www.edpb.europa.eu/system/files/2024-10/edpb_guidelines_202401_legitimateinterest_en.pdf ; See also EDPB "Opinion 11/2024 on the use of facial recognition to streamline airport passengers' flow (compatibility with Articles 5(1)(e) and(f), 25 and 32 GDPR, Version 1.1, adopted on 23 May 2024", paragraph 32, https://www.edpb.europa.eu/system/files/2024-05/edpb_opinion_202411_facialrecognitionairports_en.pdf

6 EDPS "Guidelines on assessing the proportionality of measures that limit the fundamental rights to privacy and to the protection", https://www.edps.europa.eu/sites/default/files/publication/19-02-25_proportionality_guidelines_en.pdf ; See also EDPB "Opinion 11/2024 on the use of facial recognition to streamline airport passengers' flow (compatibility with Articles 5(1)(e) and(f), 25 and 32 GDPR, Version 1.1, adopted on 23 May 2024", paragraph 32, https://www.edpb.europa.eu/system/files/2024-05/edpb_opinion_202411_facialrecognitionairports_en.pdf

4 RISK ASSESSMENT AND MANAGEMENT

4.1 Risk assessment and management

4.1.a Impacts on the rights and freedoms of the data subjects caused by non-default, accidental, unlawful, or abnormal events

Note: Identify, at least, threats that could lead to illegitimate access, undesired modification and disappearance of data.

Threats posed by malfunctions and deviations from design and default, threats to data confidentiality, integrity and availability (related to cybersecurity), etc.	How can it be materialised?	Risk sources (exposures and errors, vulnerabilities etc.)	Impacts on data subjects' rights and freedoms
1			

4.1.b Method

Explain the details of the method followed to assess and manage risk and provide the necessary information to interpret the following:

- Likelihood and severity levels and their meanings (often a 2 to 5 levels scale is used).
- Risk metrics.
- How to prioritise risks.
- Risk acceptance levels.

If an established method is used, provide the link to the external source introducing this method⁷.

4.1.c Inherent risk assessment

Note: If available, this table can be supplemented with one or more diagrams, charts, maps, priority lists, etc. documenting inherent risk assessment from different perspectives.

	Risks to the data subject's rights and freedoms (include scenarios laid out in the first column in 3.1 and 4.1.a)	Likelihood ⁸	Severity ⁹	Modulating factors	Risk level	Discuss whether the risk is acceptable or not
1						

⁷ For example, the documents listed in the Annex included in the explainer document.

⁸ A risk in data protection may be deemed non-acceptable if the potential severity of its impact is very high, even when its likelihood of occurring is low. This means that if the consequences for data subjects could be extremely serious, the risk may be considered unacceptable, regardless of how rarely the event is expected to occur.

⁹ Idem.

4.2 Action plan

4.2.a Additional mitigating measures

Note: Include in this table all types of measures (see the different categories in section 2.3)

	Technical, legal/contractual and organisational measures	Mitigated risks (considering 4.1.c)	Discussion of appropriateness and effectiveness	Implementation status (partially implemented/implemented)
1				☐ Planned ☐ Partially implemented ☐ Implemented

4.2.b Residual risk assessment

	Reassessed risks to the data subject's rights and freedoms	Additional mitigating measures that apply	Residual likelihood	Residual severity	Residual risk level	Discuss whether the risk is acceptable or not
1						

4.2.c Plan

Provide information about the necessary activities to properly add these new measures to the processing, so as to properly manage the risks for the rights and freedoms of individuals, and to monitor, review and update the proposed measures once the processing is being carried out.

- Specific activities, responsible team, timelines, etc.
- Links to external documentation or annexes with the details.

5 INVOLVEMENT OF INTERESTED PARTIES

5.1 DPO advice

- If there is a DPO (or a similar function), provide their opinion, conclusions and recommendations concerning the envisaged processing.
- Explain how the DPO's advice has been implemented.

5.2 Views of data subjects or their representatives

- Where appropriate, provide the data subjects' (or their representatives') opinion, conclusions and recommendations concerning the envisaged processing.
- Explain their participation in the DPIA process, including explanations of why it has not been considered appropriate for them to participate or why it has not been possible for them to do so.

6 CONCLUSION AND DECISION

Based on the assessment of risks and rights, the following decision has been taken:

- ☐ **REJECTED:** The processing must be abandoned.
- ☐ **CONSULTATION:** The processing will be consulted with the SA (see **Error! Reference source not found.**).
 - ☐ Yes, the data controller cannot find sufficient measures to reduce the risks to an acceptable level (i.e. the residual risks are still high) and does not wish to abandon the processing.
 - ☐ Yes, there is a national law requiring the controller to consult with, and/or obtain prior authorisation from, the SA in relation to processing by a controller for the performance of a task carried out by the controller in the public interest, including processing in relation to social protection and public health (Article 36(5) GDPR).
- ☐ **APPROVED:** The processing may proceed [immediately]. The residual risks are acceptable and there is no national law requiring consultation or prior authorisation from the Supervisory Authority (Article 36(5) GDPR).
- ☐ **CONDITIONALLY APPROVED:** The processing may proceed only after the following conditions are met:
 - *Condition 1:* _____
 - *Condition 2:* _____

Optionally, justify the decision made:

For the European Data Protection Board

The Chair

Anu Talus



Template [2026] for Data Protection Impact Assessment ('DPIA')

Explainer

Version 1.0

Adopted on 10 March 2026

Version history

Version	Date	Adoption information
version 1.0	10 March 2026	adoption of the guidelines for public consultation

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The European Data Protection Board has adopted the following template - explainer:

The EDPB template can be used as a data entry for Data Protection Impact Assessment ('DPIA') documenting and reporting. Controllers can benefit from pre-defined fields that prompt complete and structured responses. Designed for ease of use, such template ensures that all necessary information is captured accurately, while minimizing errors and saving time.

This explainer document provides a concise explanation for completing this template effectively. This document is just an explanatory tool, intended to be useful for both controllers and Supervisory Authorities (SAs) and does not preclude the publication of other additional explanations, visual aids, or guides.

Controllers can conduct their risk analysis and management processes as they prefer, using the DPIA methodology of their choice (see Annex A). The EDPB template is one way to record the most important results, a minimum amount of information that should always be documented, in the format adopted by the EDPB and easily accepted by all SAs.

It is recommended to review the entire template before starting to understand its flow, gather all required data (such as dates, descriptions, and supporting evidence/documentation), use concise language, and expand only where elaboration is requested. Certain redundancy between the DPIA template sections ensures that each mandatory element is addressed explicitly and in a traceable manner, while enabling cross-referencing. Furthermore, the same fact serves different functions across sections. Please ensure that appropriate links are established between sections, where necessary, and provide consistent information across the different tables.

0 OVERVIEW OF THE PROCESSING

0.1 Controller(s)

- 0 Identify the GDPR controller. Provide all necessary contact details (management units responsible for the processing inside the organisation, main establishment and point of contact, representative, DPO, etc.). If applicable, identify Joint controllers. Clearly define each party's obligations and tasks¹.

0.2 Processor(s) and sub-processor(s)

- 1 Identify the processors/sub-processors involved in the processing with the unequivocal definition of their obligations and tasks¹.

0.3 Name of the processing

- 2 Provide the internal name given to the processing (the given name in the record of processing activities), and, if possible, identify the current version explaining the history of changes made to the processing in the past, if any.

0.4 Planning of the processing

- 3 Provide the estimated launch date by the controller.
- 4 Provide the estimated end date or expiration conditions (if applicable, i.e. because the processing is temporary, for example, associated with a project with a limited duration).

0.5 DPIA technical sheet

- 5 Identify the current version of the DPIA template and provide a version log (explaining the history of changes made to the information contained in the DPIA template for this processing, if any).
- 6 Identify the team involved in conducting this DPIA. You can provide details of their roles, tasks, responsibilities, etc. A RACI (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed) matrix can be used.
- 7 List the guidelines, standards, codes of conduct, and other reference materials used to conduct this DPIA².
- 8 Explain the reasons to conduct the DPIA³. It may be mandatory or there may be reasons that, in the opinion of the controller, make the DPIA necessary or beneficial. More than one checkbox may be selected.
- 9 Clarify the scope of this DPIA: identify what has been considered and what has been left out of the assessment and why, what are the boundaries of the assessment.

¹ EDPB Guidelines 07/2020 on the concepts of controller and processor in the GDPR, https://www.edpb.europa.eu/system/files/en?file=2023-10/EDPB_guidelines_202007_controllerprocessor_final_en.pdf

² Guidelines on Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA) (wp248rev.01), https://ec.europa.eu/newsroom/just/document.cfm?doc_id=47711

³ Guidelines on Data Protection Impact Assessment (DPIA) (wp248rev.01), https://ec.europa.eu/newsroom/just/document.cfm?doc_id=47711

- 10 Provide the completion date and the formal validation date: the DPIA must be formally approved by a responsible official (Managing Director, CEO, etc.) as complete and finished. The DPIA template might include a seal and signature. Information about the decision-making, validation, monitoring and review methods for the DPIA may be requested, and it should be documented somewhere although it is not included in this template.
- 11 Explain whether and to what extent the DPIA is intended to be published or to be shared externally. While it may be a good practice from a transparency point of view, sensitive information should not be published (concerning security, for example).

1 SYSTEMATIC DESCRIPTION OF THE PROCESSING

1.1 High-level description of the processing

1.1.1 Processed personal data

- 12 List the processed personal data (items or elements, data type, data subject category, etc.). Identify, if applicable, special categories of personal data.

1.1.2 Purposes of the processing

- 13 Identify the specific and explicit reasons for processing the personal data listed in 1.1.1. Consider the objectives that the processing aims to achieve, its high-level goals in the operational sense, and how the processing contributes to that result (e.g. supporting a business process, policy implementation, user experience (UX) and accessibility, or safety/security goals).

1.1.3 Secondary or compatible uses

- 14 Refer to an existing analysis (documented somewhere, not in this template) or examine any secondary or compatible uses of the data (compatibility assessment). State clearly whether data listed in 1.1.1 may be re-used for another purpose, and under what conditions, applying the purpose limitation principle.

1.1.4 Nature, scope and context of the processing

- 15 Describe the nature of the processing: the way personal data will be handled (operations involved, technologies used, etc.).
- 16 Describe the scope of the processing: breadth and extent considering the volume or scale given the number of data subjects or data items, geographical and organisational reach, frequency or duration for the data subject (processing recurrence from the data subject's perspective, i.e. per use / per session, periodically, continuous or near-continuous, event-driven or occasionally)
- 17 Describe the context of the processing: circumstances and environment (use cases, supported business processes, status of the controller and relationship with the data subjects, data subjects categories and potential vulnerable groups, cross-border processing, international transfers, etc.). Cross-border processing means either a processing of personal data which takes place in the context of the activities of establishments in more than one Member State of a controller or processor in the Union

where the controller or processor is established in more than one Member State; or a processing of personal data which takes place in the context of the activities of a single establishment of a controller or processor in the Union but which substantially affects or is likely to substantially affect data subjects in more than one Member State. International transfers are transfers of personal data to a third country or an international organisation (an organisation and its subordinate bodies governed by public international law, or any other body which is set up by, or on the basis of, an agreement between two or more countries).

1.2 Functional description

- 18 Outline the processing in a structured way, decomposing it into phases or stages. Include information about the full chain composed of controller, processors and sub-processors.
- 19 Explain the data lifecycle and data flows: provide a comprehensive overview of how personal data is managed throughout its entire lifecycle, from collection to deletion. Key aspects to include:

Collection: Describe what data is collected and how, including the sources and the information provided to data subjects.

Use: Detail the operations performed on the data, the technologies used, and any automated decision-making or profiling involved. Clarify how data is used and whether it is combined with other datasets.

Storage: Specify where and how data is stored (physical, cloud, third-party), and who has access to the data.

Sharing and Transfer: Explain any data sharing to third parties or transfers outside the EU, and the legal mechanisms or tools used (e.g., SCCs, adequacy decisions).

Deletion and Destruction: Specify the criteria and procedures for securely deleting data when it is no longer needed, including methods for permanent erasure.

1.3 Means of processing, supporting assets and underlying architecture

- 20 From the functional description in section 1.2, explain the means of processing. Cover how the processing is performed, technical and organisational methods, tools, infrastructure and resources used to carry out the processing on personal data.

Specifically, provide a list or inventory of the essential supporting assets. An “asset” typically refers to any resource, tangible or intangible, that is used to process personal data, enabling an effective management throughout its lifecycle. Assets represent vectors for both value and risk in the context of data protection. Examples of assets are hardware, infrastructure, and network assets (i.e., servers, laptops, mobile devices, storage media, scanners, VPN gateways), software (database engines, business applications), APIs and models, personnel (users, administrators, developers, operators, support staff, decision-makers), sites and premises (data centres, archives), organisational assets (policies, procedures, contracts with processor and sub-processors), etc.

Include assets that are essential for risk analysis, i.e. whose compromise would plausibly impact rights and freedoms in a non-trivial way (for example, assets directly storing or processing personal data, assets that control access or protect data, exposed or high-impact components such as public-facing portals, APIs or, data-sharing interfaces to third parties). Very small, generic, or easily substitutable elements usually do not need individual listing.

Group the assets by logical module, by technical layer, by function, etc. Within each group, briefly state what it contains and how it relates to the processing, then use that level of granularity in the risk assessment and management later. Balance completeness and manageability, keep the very detailed inventory (per device, per service, etc.) in separate technical documentation and provide an explanation of the underlying architecture closely related to risk assessment and management.

1.4 Compliance with approved codes of conduct

- 21 Identify compliance with approved codes of conduct. Analyse the compliance obligation, if applicable; or the reasons that, in the opinion of the controller, make such compliance necessary or beneficial.

2 ANALYSIS OF THE PROCESSING

2.1 Lawfulness of the processing

2.1.1 Legal basis

- 22 Analyse the legal basis of the processing. The analysis of each legal basis should be carried out in relation to each of the purposes of the processing (1.1.2) including secondary or compatible purposes (1.1.3).
- 23 If applicable, refer to an existing analysis (documented elsewhere, not in this template) or analyse the legitimate interests pursued by the controller or by a third party and conduct a balancing test⁴. If this analysis relies on any hypothesis on the implemented measures, residual risks, etc. please ensure they are properly reported in the appropriate sections in this template.

2.1.2 Reasons to lift the processing prohibition

- 24 If special categories of data are processed (see 1.1.1 Processed personal data), the reasons that led to the lifting of the prohibition on processing special categories of data must be properly identified and justified.

2.2 Data minimisation, retention periods, and data quality

2.2.1 Data minimisation and retention periods

- 25 Document in detail the justification to process personal data listed in 1.1.1, identifying recipients and providing retention periods. Justify the design choices too.

2.2.2 Data quality

- 26 Provide data quality metrics, requirements or thresholds.

⁴ EDPB Guidelines 1/2024 on processing of personal data based on Article 6(1)(f) GDPR:
https://www.edpb.europa.eu/system/files/2024-10/edpb_guidelines_202401_legitimateinterest_en.pdf

2.3 Measures supporting compliance

2.3.1 Measures supporting compliance with principles in Article 5(1)(a-f) GDPR

- 27 List the measures contributing to the compliance with the principles established in Article 5(1)(a-f) GDPR (data minimisation, purpose limitation, accuracy, etc.) and discuss their appropriateness and effectiveness. Describe the implementation status of each safeguard at the time of the assessment: (a) Planned (the safeguard is only at the intention or design stage, it has been identified as necessary, but is not yet deployed in production); (b) Partially implemented (some elements of the measure are in place, but important aspects are missing or incomplete) or (c) Implemented (the measure exists, is deployed, and is effectively operating in the live environment, not just on paper, there is evidence that the control works as intended).

2.3.2 Measures supporting the exercise of data subjects' rights

- 28 List the measures envisaged to comply with the GDPR, taking into account the rights of the data subjects, inter alia, information provided to data subjects (Articles 12, 13 and 14 GDPR), right of access and to data portability (Articles 15 and 20 GDPR), right to rectification and to erasure (Articles 16, 17 and 19 GDPR), right to object and to restriction of processing (Article 18, 19, 21 and 22 GDPR) and discuss their appropriateness and effectiveness. Describe the implementation status of such measures.

2.3.3 Measures supporting compliance with other GDPR requirements

- 29 List the measures envisaged to comply with the GDPR, taking into account consent requirements (Article 7 GDPR), relationships with processors (Article 28 GDPR) and safeguards relating to international transfer(s) (Chapter V GDPR). Discuss their appropriateness and effectiveness and describe their implementation status.

2.3.4 Measures supporting data protection by design and by default

- 30 List the measures contributing to the compliance with data protection by design and by default⁵ (Article 25 GDPR), discuss their appropriateness and effectiveness and describe their implementation status.

2.3.5 Measures supporting security of the processing

- 31 List the measures contributing to the security of the processing (Article 32 GDPR), discuss their appropriateness and effectiveness and describe their implementation status. Consider measures supporting the pseudonymisation and encryption of personal data, the ability to ensure the ongoing confidentiality, integrity, availability and resilience of processing systems and services, the ability to restore the availability and access to personal data in a timely manner in the event of a physical or technical incident, etc.

⁵ EDPB Guidelines 4/2019 on Article 25 Data Protection by Design and by Default
https://www.edpb.europa.eu/sites/default/files/files/file1/edpb_guidelines_201904_dataprotection_by_design_and_by_default_v2.0_en.pdf

3 CONSIDERATIONS ON NECESSITY AND PROPORTIONALITY

3.1 Impacts of the processing on the rights and freedoms of the data subjects

- 32 Explain how the threats that the planned processing (as it has been designed and is projected to be implemented, including technical, legal/contractual and organisational measures to mitigate risk) poses to the rights and freedoms of the data subjects can be materialised and identify their impacts and all possible risk sources. These are risks that exist even if everything works exactly as designed and all actors follow the rules.

These threats flow, mainly, from the processed personal data (1.1.1), the very purpose of the processing (1.1.2) and its nature, scope and context (1.1.4). Even if the processing is correctly implemented and works as specified, there are risks tied to its inherent and structural characteristics: everything goes as intended, but design choices themselves create risks for data subjects' rights and freedoms, even where there is no failure or attack. A threat is any circumstance or event with the potential to adversely impact data subject's rights and freedoms (for example, linking, identifying, inaccuracy or data disclosure) and it may cause physical, material or non-material damage to data subjects.

A risk source is the origin or underlying cause from which a threat can materialise. Typical examples are the characteristics of the processing itself i.e., its purpose, wrong design and weaknesses (for example, use of unique identifiers, or long retention periods), exposures, etc.

Impact is the consequences that can be expected from the threat materialisation, always considering data subject's rights and freedoms (see recital 75 GDPR, for example).

3.2 Assess the necessity of the processing

- 33 Assess the necessity of the processing⁶. Evaluate if the envisaged processing is effective and the least intrusive for the data subject's rights and freedoms. Analyse if the processing demonstrably works as intended, at least to the appropriate or required level. Provide evidence (for example, concerning the different considered alternatives and their effectiveness in achieving the purpose) and justification.

3.3 Assess the proportionality of the processing

- 34 Assess the proportionality of the processing⁷, remember that necessity is a pre-condition for proportionality. Discuss the importance of the processing and its potential benefits for

⁶ EDPS "Assessing the necessity of measures that limit the fundamental right to the protection of personal data: A Toolkit", https://www.edps.europa.eu/sites/default/files/publication/17-04-11_necessity_toolkit_en_0.pdf ; See also Opinion 11/2024 on the use of facial recognition to streamline airport passengers' flow (compatibility with Articles 5(1)(e) and(f), 25 and 32 GDPR) https://www.edpb.europa.eu/our-work-tools/our-documents/opinion-board-art-64/opinion-112024-use-facial-recognition-streamline_en

⁷ EDPS "Guidelines on assessing the proportionality of measures that limit the fundamental rights to privacy and to the protection", https://www.edps.europa.eu/sites/default/files/publication/19-02-25_proportionality_guidelines_en.pdf ; See also Opinion 11/2024 on the use of facial recognition to streamline airport passengers' flow (compatibility with Articles 5(1)(e) and(f), 25 and 32 GDPR) https://www.edpb.europa.eu/our-work-tools/our-documents/opinion-board-art-64/opinion-112024-use-facial-recognition-streamline_en 8

the data subject, your organization and collectively. The advantages resulting from the processing should not be outweighed by the disadvantages it causes with respect to the exercise of individuals fundamental rights and freedoms (consider the results obtained in 3.1 to reflect on the balance advantage/disadvantage, benefit/cost). You should answer this question with complete and updated information: is the processing envisaged to fulfil the purpose a proportionate response to the need you have, given the limitations to the data protection and privacy rights? Provide evidence and justification.

4 RISK ASSESSMENT AND MANAGEMENT

4.1 Risk assessment and management

4.1.1 Impacts on the rights and freedoms of the data subjects caused by non-default, accidental, unlawful, or abnormal events

- 35 Explain how non-default, accidental, unlawful, or abnormal events pose a threat to the data subject's rights and freedoms, and how these can be materialised. Identify their impacts and all possible risk sources. Consider threats posed by malfunctions and deviations from design and default, threats to data confidentiality, integrity and availability (related to cybersecurity), etc. Identify, at least, threats that could lead to illegitimate access, undesired modification and disappearance of data.

These threats are different from those identified in 3.1 because they materialise when something does not go as intended in the design, implementation, configuration or operation, or when there are malicious actors. The root cause is a deviation from the intended, compliant state.

For the definition of a threat, see above (para 32).

A risk source is the origin or underlying cause from which a threat can materialise. Typical examples in this context are software bugs, misconfigurations, wrong access rights, operational errors (sending data to the wrong recipient, wrong dataset used, forgotten de-provisioning), lack of maintenance (unpatched vulnerabilities, outdated components), insider abuse (staff exceeding their authorised use) or external attacks (phishing, ransomware).

For the notion of impact see above (para 32).

4.1.2 Method

- 36 Explain the details of the method followed to assess and manage risk. Provide the information necessary to understand and interpret the following aspects: likelihood and severity levels and their meanings (often a 2 to 5 levels scale is used), risk metrics, how risks are prioritised, risk acceptance levels, etc. If an established method is used, provide the link to the external source introducing this method⁸.

4.1.3 Inherent risk assessment

- 37 Considering the identified threats, their risk sources and impacts, list the specific risks to the data subject's rights and freedoms posed by the processing. Include scenarios laid out in subsections 3.1 and 4.1.1. For a specific data processing, inherent risk is the risk

⁸ For example, the documents listed in the Annex.

level the controller assigns to the planned processing assuming the baseline or initial set of planned measures.

A risk is a scenario describing an event (the threat materialisation) and its consequences. The risk level expresses the extent to which data subjects are affected by the corresponding threat and typically a function of: (i) the likelihood of the threat materialisation; and (ii) the magnitude of the adverse impacts that would arise if the threat materialises (severity). Estimate the likelihood and severity of all the identified risks to the rights and freedoms of data subjects.

Identify risk modulating factors, characteristics that increase or decrease the likelihood or severity of a risk (without being the primary source of the corresponding threat). Examples of aggravating (upward-modulating) factors are a very large number of data subjects or high data sensitivity, data subjects in a situation of dependency or vulnerability (children, patients, workers, migrants), or high exposure to external adversaries. Mitigating (downward-modulating) factors are design choices and measures (section 2.3).

Risk level calculation usually follows the standard $\text{Risk} = \text{likelihood} \times \text{severity}$, typically using qualitative scales to derive a level (for example, low/medium/high). Follow the method explained or identified in 4.1.2. Modulating factors, not always present, may help in adjusting the baseline risk ($\text{likelihood} \times \text{severity}$) up or down to reflect real-world nuances for this specific processing and its context.

- 38 Assess inherent risks considering their likelihood and severity⁹ and other modulating factors.
- 39 Clearly identify risks; non-acceptable risks requiring additional mitigation before the envisaged personal data processing can take place.
- 40 If available, provide additional visual aids (such as diagrams, charts, maps, priority lists, etc.) to document the inherent risk assessment from different perspectives.

4.2 Action plan

4.2.1 Additional mitigating measures

- 41 Detail any additional (i.e. not initially planned) appropriate technical, legal/contractual and organisational measures to manage specific risks (from 4.1.3), describe their implementation status, and discuss their appropriateness and effectiveness. Include all types of measures (see section 2.3): measures supporting compliance with principles in Article 5 GDPR, measures supporting the exercise of data subjects' rights, measures supporting compliance with other GDPR requirements, measures supporting data protection by design and by default, and security measures.

4.2.2 Residual risk assessment

- 42 Residual risk is the risk that still remains after the controller has reflected on the unacceptable or excessively high risks, has decided to add additional mitigating measures, and has assessed how far those new measures actually reduce the inherent (initial or baseline) risk.

⁹ A risk in data protection may be deemed non-acceptable if the potential severity of its impact is very high, even when its likelihood of occurring is low. This means that if the consequences for data subjects could be extremely serious, the risk may be considered unacceptable, regardless of how rarely the event is expected to occur.

- 43 Reassess risks considering all these new measures. If available, provide additional visual aids (such as diagrams, charts, maps, priority lists, etc.), documenting inherent risk assessment from different perspectives.

4.2.3 Plan

- 44 Provide information about the necessary activities to properly add these new measures to the processing so as to properly manage the risks for the rights and freedoms of individuals (responsible team, timelines, etc.), and to monitor, review and update the proposed measures once the processing is being carried out. Refer or link external documentation or annexes with the details.

5 INVOLVEMENT OF INTERESTED PARTIES

5.1 DPO advice

- 45 If there is a DPO (or a similar function), provide their opinion, conclusions and recommendations concerning the envisaged processing (for instance, document any input from the DPO on risks and how to mitigate them).
- 46 Outline the actions taken following the DPO's advice through the process of conducting the DPIA and planning the processing. Answer the question "How the controller has implemented DPO's advice?".

5.2 Views of data subjects or their representatives

- 47 Where appropriate, provide the data subjects' (or their representatives') opinion, conclusions and recommendations concerning the envisaged processing.
- 48 Explain their participation in the DPIA process, including explanations of why it has not been considered appropriate for them to participate or why it has not been possible for them to do so.

6 CONCLUSION AND DECISION

- 49 Conclude with the decision on the data processing viability: (a) abandon the data processing (risks are unacceptable, any of the required tests cannot be passed, advised by the DPO, data subjects or Supervisory Authority, etc.); (b) consult with the SA ; (c) proceed with data processing as planned, or (d) conditionally proceed with data processing (i.e., by modifying the data processing design to better address identified risks). In the latter, explain the specific conditions that must be met before proceeding with the processing (for example by linking them to previous sections in the template, i.e., subsection 4.2).
- 50 Optionally, explain/justify your decision.

For the European Data Protection Board

The Chair

Anu Talus

Annex 1 : SAS' GUIDELINES TO CONDUCT DPIAS

Please also take note that the EDPB data protection guide for small business may help when conducting DPIAs: https://www.edpb.europa.eu/sme-data-protection-guide/home_en

Supervisory Authority	Link
1. Austria (AT)	https://dsb.gv.at/faqs/verpflichtungen-fuer-unternehmen
2. Belgium (BE)	
3. Bulgaria (BG)	https://cpdp.bg/%d1%81%d0%bf%d0%b8%d1%81%d1%8a%d0%ba-%d0%bd%d0%b0-%d0%b2%d0%b8%d0%b4%d0%be%d0%b2%d0%b5%d1%82%d0%b5-%d0%be%d0%bf%d0%b5%d1%80%d0%b0%d1%86%d0%b8%d0%b8-%d0%bf%d0%be-%d0%be%d0%b1%d1%80%d0%b0%d0%b1%d0%be/ https://cpdp.bg/%D1%81%D0%BF%D0%B8%D1%81%D1%8A%D0%BA-%D0%BD%D0%B0-%D0%BE%D0%BF%D0%B5%D1%80%D0%B0%D1%86%D0%B8%D0%B8%D1%82%D0%B5-%D0%BF%D0%BE-%D0%BE%D0%B1%D1%80%D0%B0%D0%B1%D0%BE%D1%82%D0%B2%D0%B0%D0%BD%D0%B5-%D0%BD/
4. Croatia (HR)	https://azop.hr/procjena-ucinka-na-zastitu-podataka-eng-data-protection-impact-assessment-dpia/ https://olivia-gdpr-arc.eu/hr/topic/show/9
5. Cyprus (CY)	
6. Czech Republic (CZ)	https://uouu.gov.cz/media/profesional/metodika-obecneho-posouzeni-vlivu-na-ochranu-osobnich-udaju.pdf
7. Denmark (DK)	https://www.datatilsynet.dk/regler-og-vejledning/behandlingssikkerhed/konsekvensanalyse
8. EDPS	
9. Estonia (EE)	https://www.aki.ee/uudised/mis-asi-mojuhinnang
10. Finland (FI)	(FI) https://tietosuoja.fi/vaikutustenarviointi (EN) https://tietosuoja.fi/en/impact-assessments
11. France (FR)	(FR) https://www.cnil.fr/fr/guides-aipd (EN) https://www.cnil.fr/en/privacy-impact-assessment-pia
12. Germany (DE)	https://www.datenschutz-mv.de/datenschutz/datenschutzmodell/
13. Greece (EL)	(EL) https://www.dpa.gr/el/foreis/ektimisi-adiktipou-kai-diavouleush , https://www.dpa.gr/foreis/ektimisi-adiktipou-kai-diavouleush/ektimisi-adiktipou (EN) https://www.dpa.gr/en/Organisations/Impact-Assessment https://www.dpa.gr/en/by-design/risk-assessment-dpia https://www.dpa.gr/en/by-design/ict-organizational-gdpr-roles-dpia
14. Hungary (HU)	
15. Iceland (IS)	

16. Ireland (IE)	https://www.dataprotection.ie/en/dpc-guidance/guide-data-protection-impact-assessments
17. Italy (IT)	
18. Latvia (LV)	https://www.dvi.gov.lv/lv/novertejums-par-ietekmi-uz-datu-aizsardzibu-nida
19. Lichtenstein	
20. Lithuania (LT)	
21. Luxembourg (LU)	
22. Malta (MT)	https://idpc.org.mt/for-organisations/data-protection-impact-assessment/
23. Netherlands (NL)	(NL) https://autoriteitpersoonsgegevens.nl/themas/basis-avg/praktisch-avg/data-protection-impact-assessment-dpia (EN) https://autoriteitpersoonsgegevens.nl/en/themes/basic-gdpr/gdpr-in-practice/data-protection-impact-assessment-dpia
24. Norway (NO)	
25. Poland (PL)	(PL): https://uodo.gov.pl/pl/598/3617 (EN): https://uodo.gov.pl/en/553/1882 https://monitorpolski.gov.pl/MP/2019/666 https://uodo.gov.pl/500 https://uodo.gov.pl/pl/138/605
26. Portugal (PT)	
27. Romania (RO)	
28. Slovakia (SK)	
29. Slovenia (SI)	https://www.ip-rs.si/fileadmin/user_upload/Pdf/Ocene_ucinkov/Smernice_o_ocenah_ucinka_DPIA_julij2018.pdf
30. Spain (ES)	(ES) https://www.aepd.es/guias/gestion-riesgo-y-evaluacion-impacto-en-tratamientos-datos-personales.pdf (EN) https://www.aepd.es/guides/risk-management-and-impact-assessment-in-processing-personal-data.pdf
31. Sweden (SE)	